

CONSUMER CHECKING · Q4 PLANNING

# Q4 Consumer Referral Refresh

Proposal v0.9 · 2025-09-18 · Prepared for finance and legal review  
Prepared by Growth Marketing (P. Shetty's team) · Presented at growth planning, 2025-09-22

WHY REFRESH NOW

# The offers have gone quiet

Referral share of new consumer checking accounts has been flat for three quarters while paid acquisition costs keep climbing. The consumer offers have not moved since the spring cycle, and the two competitors we price-watch refreshed twice this year.

3 qtrs

referral share of new accounts flat

-1.8pt

invite-to-open conversion drift since the spring cycle

2x

competitor refreshes in the same window

THE PROPOSAL

v0.9 model numbers – four products

| PRODUCT    | REFERRER BONUS | REFERRED BONUS | QUALIFYING DEPOSIT   | ANNUAL CAP |
|------------|----------------|----------------|----------------------|------------|
| Blue       | \$30           | \$25           | \$400 within 90 days | 6          |
| Gold Years | \$60           | \$60           | \$750 within 90 days | 4          |
| Light Blue | \$25           | \$15           | \$350 within 90 days | 4          |
| Purple     | \$50           | \$30           | \$800 within 90 days | 5          |

v0.9 model output for review – every cell stays open until finance sign-off. Tenure thresholds: no change proposed in v0.9. One deliberate simplification: standardize the qualifying-deposit window at 90 days across all four, so the desk quotes one window instead of four.

COST MODEL

What v0.9 costs against run-rate

\$612k

modeled Q4 promo cost at v0.9 numbers

\$488k

current run-rate for the same quarter

9 mo

modeled payback on the incremental spend

- ▶ **Most sensitive cell:** the Gold Years pair – the September model assumes the richer referred bonus converts the 62+ waitlist, and finance should pressure-test exactly that.
- ▶ **Least sensitive:** the standardized window. It moves quote accuracy more than cost.

September model run, acquisition mix held flat. Planning estimates; nothing on this page is a customer term.

## RISKS &amp; OPEN QUESTIONS

## What v0.9 does not settle

- ▶ **Cap increases need a fraud re-run.** Risk has flagged that any cap movement re-opens the abuse model; that work is not yet scheduled.
- ▶ **Cross-product wording.** Legal wants one pass over how the four offers describe each other before anything publishes.
- ▶ **The pages will lag.** The web rebuild is queued behind the promo freeze, so launch comms cannot depend on page updates – plan around announcement notes, not page copy.
- ▶ **The standardized window is a bet.** Finance may split the windows back out by product; the model supports either.

TIMELINE

Decision path to a late-October launch



The go-live notes carry whatever finance signs off, which may not match v0.9. Anyone quoting Q4 terms quotes the launch announcement, not the planning deck.

## THE ASK

## Approve the direction, hold the numbers

We are asking the planning session to approve the four-product refresh and the incremental budget envelope. Every value in the v0.9 table stays open until finance sign-off, and the launch date holds only if the fraud re-run clears the cap changes.

- ▶ Decision requested 2025-09-22: refresh direction + budget envelope.
- ▶ Not requested today: any specific bonus, deposit, or cap value.